

HOUSING FOR THE FUTURE 6



L'Arbre Blanc, Montpellier, France

IN THIS UNIT, YOU WILL:

- Watch or listen to a lecture about housing solutions
- Watch a video about steel container buildings
- Listen to an interview about how to build a new city
- Present a house and sell it
OR Plan a new city

THINK AND DISCUSS:

L'Arbre Blanc is an apartment building in Montpellier, France. The name means *the white tree*. It is called this because the balconies look like leaves on a tree.

1. What do you think is the reason for this design?
2. Do you want to live in a building like this? Explain.

EXPLORE THE THEME

Read the information. Then discuss the questions.

1. What three things do they use to measure sustainable cities? Do these things all have the same importance?
2. Are any of the cities in your country? Do any of the results surprise you?
3. What score do you give your town or city for each category (people, planet, money)?

Sustainable Cities



Sustainable cities are healthy cities. They are comfortable for people to live in. This ranking measures these things:



PEOPLE

Health, education, fair pay, and living costs



PLANET

Energy use, amount of green space, and pollution



MONEY

The business environment, including tourism, employment, and health of the economy

A ranking of 100 of the world's cities

Overall Rank			
1	Oslo	1	39
3	Tokyo	7	20
6	London	22	6
9	Zürich	2	51
10	Amsterdam	10	14
15	New York	42	36
16	Frankfurt	26	15
35	Singapore	5	69
41	Toronto	29	57
66	Shanghai	49	75
71	Kuala Lumpur	62	73
74	Istanbul	74	55
86	Cairo	79	89
96	Nairobi	98	82



Source: Arcadis

A

Vocabulary

A Listen and repeat. Check (✓) any words you already know. 

architect (n)	engineer (n)	ground (n)	luxury (adj)	safe (adj)
comfortable (adj)	float (v)	look like (v phr)	resident (n)	solution (n)

B **MEANING FROM CONTEXT** Read and listen to the article. Think about the meaning of the words in blue. Write each word next to its definition. 



THE BURJ AL ARAB

The Burj Al Arab is a **luxury** hotel in the city of Dubai. From a distance, it **looks like** the sails on a ship, and the hotel seems to **float** on the water. But, in fact, it sits on a small human-made island.

When they started the project, **engineers** did not know how to create the new island, but they found a **solution**. They used concrete and rocks. It took three years to move enough sand and create **safe ground** above the water. Then an **architect** designed the famous hotel.

Now, the Burj Al Arab has some of the most **comfortable** and expensive rooms in the world. Across from the hotel, local **residents** in Dubai often see helicopters arrive at the top of the building with rich, and sometimes famous, guests.

- _____ (adj) not dangerous
- _____ (n) an answer to a problem or difficult situation
- _____ (n) a person who designs buildings
- _____ (v phr) to appear similar to something else

5. _____ (n) a person who lives in a particular place
6. _____ (adj) making you feel relaxed
7. _____ (n) the earth; the thing you stand or sit on outside
8. _____ (n) a person who designs and builds machines, roads, etc.
9. _____ (adj) expensive and high-quality
10. _____ (v) to stay on top of the water

VOCABULARY SKILL Adjective Suffixes

You can create adjectives from some nouns and verbs. Common adjective suffixes include *-able*, *-ive*, *-ful*, and *-ous*. When you add a suffix to a word, use a dictionary to check the spelling.

Noun/Verb	Adjective
comfort	comfortable
create	creative
care	careful
danger	dangerous

- **C** Add suffixes to the nouns and verbs to make adjectives. Use a dictionary to help you.

Verb/Noun	Adjective	Verb/Noun	Adjective
1. act	_____	5. fame	_____
2. beauty	_____	6. nerve	_____
3. enjoy	_____	7. use	_____
4. expense	_____	8. value	_____

- D CREATE** Choose THREE adjectives from exercise C and make sentences with them. Then read your sentences to a partner.

Critical Thinking

> *There's a beautiful hotel in the center of my town.*

- **E PERSONALIZE** Complete these questions with the adjective form of the word in parentheses. Then ask and answer the questions with a partner.

1. Are there any _____ buildings in your town? What do they **look like**? (beauty)
2. Do you know the names of any _____ **architects**? (fame)
3. Did you ever go up in a very tall building? How far off the **ground** were you?
Were you _____? (nerve)
4. Do you have any **luxury** hotels in your town? What makes them look _____?
(expense)

A Listening Housing Solutions

Critical Thinking

A ACTIVATE You are going to hear a lecture about housing solutions. Look at the photo and answer these questions.

1. What is the problem for the people in the photo? What is their housing solution?
2. What are three words you think you will hear in the lecture?

B MAIN IDEAS Watch or listen to the lecture. Match the solutions to the countries.  

- | | |
|-------------------------|--------------------|
| 1. ____ a bamboo house | a. Bangladesh |
| 2. ____ the FLOAT House | b. the Netherlands |
| 3. ____ the LIFT House | c. Vietnam |
| 4. ____ houseboats | d. USA |

Flooding can be a problem in southern Cambodia, but these residents are safe in this house.



- **C DETAILS** Watch or listen again and check (✓) the features of each type of house in the chart. Some features are true for more than one type of house. 🔊 ▶

Which house ... ?	Bamboo house	FLOAT House	LIFT House	Houseboat
1. is built above the ground	☒	☐	☐	☐
2. can float	☐	☐	☐	☐
3. can move to different places	☐	☐	☐	☐
4. moves up and down from the ground	☐	☐	☐	☐
5. uses cheap building materials	☐	☐	☐	☐
6. uses plastic water bottles	☐	☐	☐	☐
7. can be very comfortable and modern	☐	☐	☐	☐

- **D FOCUSED LISTENING** Each noun phrase is missing THREE words. Listen to these parts of the lecture and complete the phrases. 🔊

- the middle _____
- 90% _____
- the bottom _____
- about one-quarter _____
- the basic design _____

LISTENING SKILL Use Context Clues

When you listen to a talk or lecture, you may not understand every word. You can use context clues to help you understand new words. These clues might be before or after the word(s).

*There's always a lot of **congestion** near my house. Every day, there are traffic jams because people are looking for places to park their cars.*
(congestion = the problem of too much traffic)

- **E** Listen to and read parts of the lecture again. Discuss these questions with a partner. 🔊

- What is the meaning of each bold word or phrase?
 - Which words before or after the bold word or phrase give context clues?
1. Water can go under the house when there is flooding. But when it's dry, you can use the area under the house as a **storage space** for plants, farm equipment, and animals.
 2. Ninety percent of the residents **evacuated** the city by car and drove to safer places further north. Afterwards, when they returned, there weren't enough houses for many of them.
 3. About one-quarter of the country is below **sea level**. That's because Dutch engineers removed the sea water and created land to build on.

- **F PERSONALIZE** Discuss these questions with a partner.

1. Which type of house from the lecture do you prefer? Why?
2. Do you have any housing problems in your country? What solutions are there?

GRAMMAR FOR SPEAKING Conjunctions *and, but, or, so*

A clause has a subject and a verb. Many sentences have more than one clause.

The apartment is clean. (= one sentence and one clause)

*The apartment is clean, **and** it's not expensive.* (= one sentence and two clauses)

We can use conjunctions to join two clauses and connect two ideas. Use conjunctions to:

Add information: *The apartment is clean, **and** it's not expensive.*

Contrast information: *The kitchen is nice, **but** the living room is too small.*

Offer a choice: *We can live downtown, **or** we can live near the beach.*

Give a result: *We want to buy a house, **so** we need to save our money.*

When we speak, we often begin a reply with a conjunction.

A: *This house has a beautiful kitchen.*

B: **And** there's a garden in the back!

A: *This house is amazing!*

B: **But** it's expensive! We can't afford it.

- **A** Choose the correct conjunction to connect the two clauses. Then say the sentences.

1. We love nature, (so / but) we want to live near a park.
2. It's a beautiful apartment, (and / but) the rent is too high.
3. I can stay here another year, (so / or) I can move to a different apartment.
4. The living room is large, (so / but) the bedrooms are small.
5. We like the house, (or / and) the neighborhood is perfect.
6. My real estate agent never answers his phone, (so / and) I'm looking for a new agent.

- **B** Work with a partner and take turns. Use words from each column to make logical sentences about Ron. More than one answer is possible.

Clause	Conjunction	Clause
Ron loves music,		he goes out with friends.
He works downtown,	and	he takes a train to work.
He's an excellent cook,	but	he goes to concerts in the city.
He often goes hiking,	or	he travels to other countries a lot.
He has a car,	so	he lives in the country.
He works for an international company,		he often eats out at restaurants.
He sometimes stays at home,		he gardens on Saturday mornings.

> *Ron loves music, so he goes to concerts in the city.*

- **C** Use the ideas in exercise B or your own ideas to tell your partner about three people you know.



Shimokitazawa in Tokyo, Japan, is a fun neighborhood with many clothing shops, cafés, and artist studios.

D CREATE Your friend is looking for an apartment. Role-play the conversations. Then switch roles. Critical Thinking

- Student A: Say the first sentence.
 - Student B: Reply with the conjunction and add your own ideas.
1. A: This apartment is very modern, and the building is new.
B: But ...
 2. A: I want to live on this street. It has a lot of good cafés.
B: And ...
 3. A: I could live in the center of the city.
B: Or ...
 4. A: The apartment is about a kilometer from our university.
B: So ...

PRONUNCIATION Sentence Stress

You often stress one or two words in a clause or sentence. You usually stress content words (words with the most meaning).

Verb:	<i>We love nature.</i>
Adjective:	<i>It's a beautiful apartment.</i>
Noun:	<i>The house also has a garden!</i>
More than one word:	<i>The house has a garden, and it has a swimming pool!</i>

Sometimes, you can also stress a conjunction to emphasize its meaning.

Emphasize the contrast:	<i>It's a beautiful apartment, but it's expensive.</i>
Emphasize the addition:	<i>It has a beautiful kitchen, and there's a garden in the back!</i>

E Listen to these sentences and mark the stressed words. Then listen again and repeat.

1. This pizza is delicious!
2. The apartment is in the city center.
3. He loves music, and he goes to concerts.
4. I like the jacket, but it's expensive.
5. You can live here, or you can live there.
6. A: The bedrooms are comfortable.
B: And they both have TVs.

F Work with a partner. Repeat a conversation from exercise D, and add stress.

A: I could live in the **center** of the city.
B: **Or** you could live **outside** the city. It's **cheaper**!

CRITICAL THINKING Rank Options

When you rank your options, you think about and compare each choice. You need to decide which option is more important and which is less important. For example, when you choose a place to live, you need to decide what is most important to you: location, size, cost, etc.

Critical Thinking

- G** You are looking for a new house or apartment. Rank the options in the list from 1 (most important) to 8 (least important).

_____ cost	_____ near green space (parks, etc.)
_____ size	_____ near work
_____ allows pets	_____ facilities (laundry, exercise room, etc.)
_____ near school	_____ has garage or other parking

- H** Work with a partner. Take turns describing the kind of place you want to live. Use the options from exercise G and your own ideas.

> *Cost is very important for me, so I want a cheap apartment.*

- I** With your partner, discuss these three houses and apartments. Then list TWO positive features and ONE negative feature about each place to live. Use the information and your own ideas.

Description	Positive	Negative
Option 1: This clean, modern two-bedroom apartment is downtown and close to the university, so it's perfect for students. It's on the third floor, and there is a resident manager.		
Option 2: This beautiful, traditional house is a comfortable place for a family or group of professional people. It's in a quiet area near schools and parks.		
Option 3: This large luxury house has a swimming pool, five bedrooms, and six bathrooms. It's close to the beach and far from the noisy city center.		

- J** Join another pair and work in groups. Compare your list of positive and negative features from exercise I. Which option is the best for each person in the group?

A: *I'm a student and option 1 is close to a university, so I won't need a car.*

B: *But it has a resident manager. So maybe there are a lot of rules! What about option 2?*

Steel Container Buildings

spring to mind (v phr) if something springs to mind, you think of it suddenly

pile up (v phr) to increase in amount, in a way that is too much

base (n) lowest part of something

spacious (adj) having a lot of space or room

▲ Container City, Trinity Buoy Wharf, London, UK

A Watch the video and number these parts of the video in order (1-3). ▶

- _____ Ian shows Johnny his steel container house.
- _____ Different kinds of transportation can move steel containers around.
- _____ There are houses made from steel containers in London.

B Read the statements. Then watch the video again and choose T for *True* or F for *False*. ▶

- | | | |
|---|---|---|
| 1. Johnny says the shipping container is a classic piece of American design from the 1960s. | T | F |
| 2. They made steel containers one size so you could transport them on trucks, trains, or ships. | T | F |
| 3. After about ten years, you can't use steel containers anymore. | T | F |
| 4. It's difficult to build a house using steel containers. | T | F |
| 5. Ian thinks living in a steel container is similar to living in a normal house. | T | F |
| 6. Ian's house is made from two containers. | T | F |

C PERSONALIZE Discuss these questions with a group.

1. Would you like to live in a shipping container? Why? Why not?
2. Can you think of three more ways to use steel shipping containers?

B

Vocabulary

A Listen and repeat. Check (✓) any words you already know. 

architecture (n)	desert (n)	government (n)	population (n)	private (adj)
crowd (n)	energy (n)	nothing (pro)	power (n)	public transportation (n phr)

B **MEANING FROM CONTEXT** Listen and write the correct form of the words from exercise A. Then think about each word's meaning. 

EGYPT'S NEW CITY

Egypt is famous for its capital city of Cairo. Every year, millions of tourists come to see the ancient ¹_____ in the area. But the city is also famous for its ²_____, busy roads, and slow ³_____. To solve some of Cairo's problems, the ⁴_____ of Egypt has built a completely new city from ⁵_____. The New Administrative Capital is in the middle of the ⁶_____, about 30 miles from Cairo. There are new buildings for the government and office buildings for ⁷_____ businesses. The city can use solar ⁸_____ for its ⁹_____, and there are electric trains for transport. When it is complete, the city will have a ¹⁰_____ of five million residents.

▼ New Administrative Capital, outside Cairo, Egypt



C Match the words in exercise A to their definitions. TWO words have the same definition.

1. _____ (n) all the people in a country or city
2. _____ (n phr) buses and trains that people can use to travel
3. _____ (n) the design and style of buildings
4. _____ (n) a large number of people together in a public place
5. _____ (pro) not anything
6. _____ (n) a place that gets little rainfall; a very dry area of land
7. _____ (n) the people who manage a country or place
8. _____ (adj) not public
9. _____ (n) what comes from electricity, gas, etc.

D Cross out the **bold** words in each sentence and write a word from exercise A.

1. The **style** _____ of these buildings is very old. They're from the last century.
2. There was a **big group** _____ at the stadium last week. I couldn't find a seat!
3. I started English with no knowledge of the language. I knew **zero** _____!
4. In 1900, the **number of people** _____ on Earth was two billion. Now it's eight.
5. All the **energy** _____ in this city comes from those wind turbines out at sea.
6. This parking lot is **not for the public** _____. You can't park here.
7. You can use a **train or a bus** _____ to get to school.
8. This plant needs very little water. It can live in a **very dry area** _____.

E PERSONALIZE How much do you know about your town or city? Write your answers.

	You	Your partner
1. What is the population ?		
2. Is the public transportation fast or slow? Is it busy?		
3. Where does most of the energy come from? Solar? Gas?		
4. How old is the architecture in the area? What's the oldest building?		
5. Is there a local government ? What is it responsible for?		

F COMPARE Work with a partner and take turns. Interview your partner with the questions in exercise E. Write your partner's answers in the chart. Then consider the following:

- If you live in the same town or city, do you have similar or different answers?
- If you live in different locations, how similar or different are your answers?

Critical Thinking

B

Listening How to Build a New City

Critical Thinking

A PREDICT You are going to listen to an architect describe how to build a new city. In what order do you think you should do these steps?

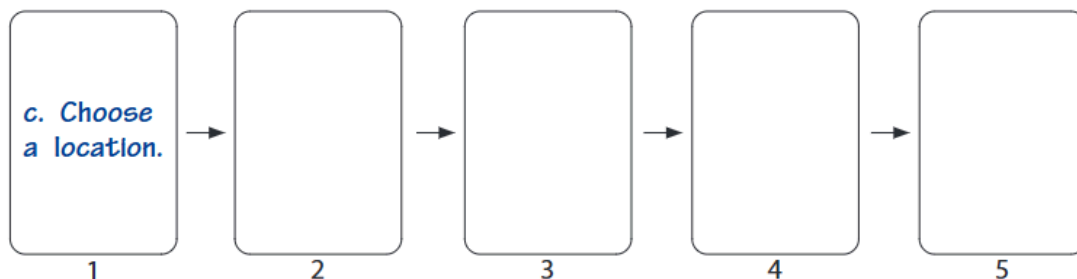
- ____ Get money from the government and businesses.
- ____ Design houses and public transportation.
- ____ Choose a location.
- ____ Create places to relax.
- ____ Figure out the energy and water.

NOTE-TAKING SKILLS Use Diagrams and Flowcharts

When you take notes about different steps in a process, it's often useful to draw a diagram or flowchart with arrows. Here are some notes from a talk about choosing a university.



B MAIN IDEAS Listen to an interview with the architect. What order does she give for the steps from exercise A? Complete the flowchart.



C DETAILS Read the statements. Then listen again and choose T for *True* or F for *False*.

- | | | |
|--|---|---|
| 1. Stuart normally talks to architects about one building. | T | F |
| 2. The government hired Zarina to help plan a new city. | T | F |
| 3. Neom in Saudi Arabia will have a population of about 19 million people. | T | F |
| 4. The new city will use water to make its power. | T | F |
| 5. It's not expensive to take the salt out of sea water. | T | F |
| 6. The new city won't allow cars. | T | F |
| 7. Songdo in South Korea has a big park in the middle of the city. | T | F |
| 8. Zarina's new city doesn't have a name yet. | T | F |

● **D FOCUSED LISTENING** Listen to five of Stuart's questions. Complete each question with TWO words. 

1. _____ you tell us about your new project?
2. _____ of location is a good choice for a new city?
3. _____ a problem for a desert city?
4. _____ modern cities move people around?
5. _____ good places to relax in a new city?

E Work with a partner. Try to remember Zarina's answers to the questions in exercise D and make short notes about each one.

F CREATE Work with a partner and role-play a conversation between Stuart and Zarina. Then switch roles and practice the conversation again.

Critical Thinking

Student A: You are Stuart. Ask the questions in exercise D.

Student B: You are Zarina. Use your notes from exercise E and answer Stuart's questions.

▼ Model showing Shanghai, China, in the future



SPEAKING SKILL Ask for and Give Opinions

When we discuss ideas, we often:

Ask for others' opinions	Give an opinion	Agree	Disagree
What do you think about...?	I think that...	I agree that...	I disagree that...
What's your opinion?	In my opinion, it...	I agree with you.	I don't agree with you.
Do you agree?		Absolutely. That's true.	Yes, but...

When we disagree, we can use expressions to be more polite.

I'm afraid I don't agree.

I'm sorry, but I disagree because...

I see what you mean, but...

- A** Cover the Speaking Skill box. Correct the common mistakes in each expression. Then practice saying the expressions correctly.

- How do you think about this idea?
- What your opinion?
- Are you agree?
- In my opinion, is a good idea.
- I am agree with you.
- I'm afraid, but I don't agree.
- I sorry, but I disagree.
- I see what it means, but I don't agree.

- B** Match each question or comment to the correct response. Then practice with a partner.

Question or comment**Response**

- What do you think about our city? ____
- I think that we need a new shopping mall. What's your opinion? ____
- In my opinion, we should have more bike paths. ____
- I don't agree that our city needs more houses. The population is too high already. ____
- We need better public transportation with more buses. ____
- I agree with you. They're a good way to get around, and riding a bike is good exercise.
- I think that it's a great place to live. There's so much to do.
- I see what you mean, but people have to live somewhere.
- Absolutely! And the price is too high.
- In my opinion, we don't need more shops because people are shopping online these days.

- C PERSONALIZE** Work with a partner and take turns.

Student A: Read a question or comment from exercise B.

Student B: Answer with a response about your own city or town.

D Work with a new partner. Discuss each of these topics. Use the expressions and structure in the Speaking Skill box.

1. the houses in your neighborhood
2. the location of your town or city (compared to the rest of the country)
3. traffic and public transportation in the area
4. places to relax and have fun

A: What do you think about the houses in your neighborhood?

B: In my opinion, they aren't very modern. I don't like the architecture. Do you agree?

A: Yes. And I also think that . . . / I'm sorry, but I disagree because . . .

E RATE Use the chart to rate the features that are most important in a city. Then work with a group and follow the steps below.

Critical Thinking

Feature	1 = Very important			5 = Not important	
• a very large city	1	2	3	4	5
• interesting architecture	1	2	3	4	5
• a lot of green space	1	2	3	4	5
• good schools and universities	1	2	3	4	5
• cheap cafés and nightlife	1	2	3	4	5
• a lot of shopping malls	1	2	3	4	5
• different museums and galleries	1	2	3	4	5
• not much traffic and noise	1	2	3	4	5

1. Ask for and give opinions about the features above. Which features are very important, and which are not important? If you disagree about a feature, discuss it and try to agree on its importance.
2. Decide which are the three most important features and report back to the class.

▼ The Muttrah area in Muscat, Oman



Review

SELF-ASSESS

How well can you ...?	Very well.	OK.	I need improvement.
use the key vocabulary	☐	☐	☐
use sentence stress	☐	☐	☐
use conjunctions <i>and, but, or, so</i>	☐	☐	☐
ask for and give opinions	☐	☐	☐

A VOCABULARY Read the clues and write the words from the unit.

- What *c* word means a lot of people?

- What *p* word is a synonym for *energy*?

- What *p* word is the opposite of *public*?

- What *a* word designs buildings?

- What *r* word lives in a city?

- What *t* word often follows *public*?

B PRONUNCIATION Say the sentences on the left and stress the bold word. Think about the information in sentences a-c and match.

- The **first** apartment was perfect. _____
- The first apartment was **perfect**. _____
- The first **apartment** was perfect. _____
- It was better than the house we saw.
- The second apartment was not very nice.
- I don't need to see any more apartments.

C GRAMMAR Complete the conversations with conjunctions.

- A: What do you like to do on weekends?
B: I like going shopping, _____ I enjoy meeting friends.
- A: I want to visit the art gallery tomorrow.
B: _____ it's closed on Mondays.
- A: Would you like a sandwich, _____ do you want a salad?
B: A sandwich is fine, thanks.
- A: Why don't you rent this apartment? It's great.
B: It's \$1000 a month, _____ I can't afford it.

D SPEAKING SKILL Unscramble the words and say the sentences.

- A: what / you / architecture / think / do / about / modern / ?
 B: my / ugly in / it / opinion / 's
 A: I / agree / are / that some / but / buildings / not all of them
 B: see / I / what / you / but / like them / mean, / I don't

RE-ASSESS What skills or language do you still need help with?

Final Tasks

OPTION 1 Present a house and sell it

A Choose a house you know well or find one online. (You can search "houses for sale in [place].") You are going to try to sell this house. Make notes about the features of the house, such as:

- architecture and appearance
- location
- size and number of rooms
- near schools and shopping
- garage, yard, or garden
- public transportation
- special rooms (laundry room, exercise room, etc.)
- any other information

B Work with a group and follow these steps.

- Each person has one minute to present and sell their house to the rest of the group.
- You can also answer questions at the end. If possible, show a picture of the house.
- At the end of each presentation, the rest of the group decides if they will buy the house.

> *Today, I'd like to sell you this house. As you can see from this photo, the architecture is beautiful. It's near a lake, and it has four large bedrooms!*

▼ A family looks around a new house with a real estate agent.



OPTION 2 Plan a new city

- A MODEL** A group of students are planning a new city. Listen and choose the correct answer or answers. 

- Which location do they choose?
 - On the sea.
 - In the desert.
 - Near the sea.
 - In a green space.
- Why do they choose it?
 - For the weather.
 - To protect farmland.
 - For solar and wind power.
 - For electric transportation.
- In the end, how many of the students agree with the choice of location?
 - One of them.
 - Two of them.
 - All three of them.

- B ANALYZE THE MODEL** Listen again. Complete these sentences with the word you hear. 

- That's _____. But what about the temperature?
- That's a great _____. It also _____ that we can use wind power.
- _____! It's good to use green energy.
- Yes, _____ all public transportation can be electric.
- We can _____ build houses with a view of the sea.
- I _____ with you.

COLLABORATION SKILL Encourage Other People in a Discussion

When other people give their opinions, try to encourage them and build on their ideas.

Encouraging each other

Absolutely! That's a great idea.
That's true. I agree with you.

Building on ideas

Yes, and ... We can also ...
It also means that ... And we need to ...

 **ONLINE** You can encourage other people when they are speaking by using a smile symbol or nodding your head to show you agree. You can also write comments in the chat.

- C PLAN** Imagine your government has given you money to plan and build an innovative new city. Think about each point below and make notes.

- location (e.g., desert? on the sea?)
- type of energy (e.g., solar? wind?)
- type of transportation
- population and number of houses
- places to relax and have fun
- the name of your city

- D PRACTICE AND DISCUSS** Work in groups. You have 10 minutes for your meeting. Discuss your ideas from exercise C and plan a new city. Talk about the things you want to include in your city, their benefits, and their challenges. You can draw plans on a large piece of paper.

- E PRESENT** Prepare and give a short group presentation of your plans to the rest of the class. Use your drawings from exercise D in the presentation.